



## Glossary terms

### Terms and definitions for Course 3, Module 2

**Bad data source:** A data source that is not reliable, original, comprehensive, current, and cited (ROCCC)

**Bias:** A conscious or subconscious preference in favor of or against a person, group of people, or thing

**Confirmation bias:** The tendency to search for or interpret information in a way that confirms pre-existing beliefs

**Consent:** The aspect of data ethics that presumes an individual's right to know how and why their personal data will be used before agreeing to provide it

**Cookie:** A small file stored on a computer that contains information about its users

**Currency:** The aspect of data ethics that presumes individuals should be aware of financial transactions resulting from the use of their personal data and the scale of those transactions

**Data anonymization:** The process of protecting people's private or sensitive data by eliminating identifying information

**Data bias:** When a preference in favor of or against a person, group of people, or thing systematically skews data analysis results in a certain direction

**Data ethics:** Well-founded standards of right and wrong that dictate how data is collected, shared, and used

**Data interoperability:** A key factor leading to the successful use of open data among companies and governments

**Data privacy:** Preserving a data subject's information any time a data transaction occurs

**Ethics:** Well-founded standards of right and wrong that prescribe what humans ought to do, usually in terms of rights, obligations, benefits to society, fairness, or specific virtues

**Experimenter bias:** The tendency for different people to observe things differently (also called observer bias)

**Fairness:** A quality of data analysis that does not create or reinforce bias

**First-party data:** Data collected by an individual or group using their own resources

**General Data Protection Regulation of the European Union (GDPR):** Policy-making body in the European Union created to help protect people and their data

**Good data source:** A data source that is reliable, original, comprehensive, current, and cited (ROCCC)

**Interpretation bias:** The tendency to interpret ambiguous situations in a positive or negative way

**Observer bias:** The tendency for different people to observe things differently (also called experimenter bias)

**Open data:** Data that is available to the public

**Openness:** The aspect of data ethics that promotes the free access, usage, and sharing of data

**Sampling bias:** Overrepresenting or underrepresenting certain members of a population as a result of working with a sample that is not representative of the population as a whole

**Transaction transparency:** The aspect of data ethics that presumes all data-processing activities and algorithms should be explainable and understood by the individual who provides the data

**Unbiased sampling:** When the sample of the population being measured is representative of the population as a whole